



Encouraging Customer Loyalty

Building a base of loyal customers or clients will help you generate a steady, sustainable income stream and bolster sales in times of uncertainty. Faithful customers who refer others to you also help boost your business.

Understanding loyalty

Some customers and clients will come back regularly to you because you are familiar and they are short of time. It takes more effort and they could feel like they are taking more of a risk to find a new place.

Other customers might buy from you because you have the cheapest prices, but they may easily be lured away by a discounting competitor. These customers are hard to keep

loyal, but if you back up sales with great customer service, you will at least receive some positive reviews.

The most loyal customers will be those who value the quality of your product, service, or brand and who enjoy the experience of purchasing through your business. Gathering and acting on feedback from your customers (see box, right) will improve your interaction with them; that, in turn, will help boost loyalty.

Promoting referrals

A loyal customer base can, in effect, become an extra promotional arm for your business. Market research shows that up to 85 percent of consumers trust online reviews as much as they do word-of-mouth referrals. The challenge is to persuade loyal customers to take the step of either telling other people about your business or brand or leaving an online review.

77% of consumers say they stayed loyal to specific brands for 10 years or more

www.inmoment.com, 2018

Creating a bond

It is easy for most customers and clients to research products, brands, and service providers online, so they will have high expectations. Attentive, personalized customer service is a vital tool in holding on to customers and developing an emotional connection with them.

Key to this emotional bond is making memories for the customer as they interact with you. Remembering names, making transactions surprisingly straightforward, and offering customers something special can all be memorable. In short, make sure that every aspect of the customer experience is positive, eliminating any negatives.

